

Year Heads & Attendance Officers

Attendance, Communication, and Student Oversight

Written by Sam Support | Last published at: February 18, 2026

Year Heads and Attendance Officers play a crucial role in supporting student wellbeing, monitoring attendance, and maintaining clear communication with parents. Whether you are responsible for a specific year group or overseeing attendance across the entire school, the Unique Schools system provides you with the tools to manage these responsibilities efficiently and securely.

This guide outlines your key responsibilities, available features, and best practices to help you get the most from the system.

Important Note

If you require Year Head or Attendance access, please contact our team at staffsupport@uniqueschools.ie

Your Main Responsibilities

1. Attendance Monitoring & Management

Core Tasks

- **Year Heads** are typically responsible for monitoring and following up on **unexplained absences** for students in their assigned year.
- In schools without Year Head-led attendance, an **Attendance Officer** or a member of the **senior leadership team** usually manages this process.

Tools You'll Use

The [Attendance Dashboard](#) allows you to:

- View **absences and lates**
- Search, filter, and manage notes efficiently
- View real-time data across the school

[📖 Help Guide on Attendance Overview](#)

2. Sending Personal Notifications (PN)

When to Use

Use **Personal Notifications** instead of email for:

- Attendance-related communication
- Behaviour alerts
- General updates to parents

Send to:

- Individual parents from the student profile
- Class groups
- Year groups
- Custom groups

Parents can **reply** to your messages in a **threaded format** similar to email if enabled before sending.

You can **close off** a conversation once it's resolved.

[!\[\]\(3211b5d1d968fc1665909b34f9f16010_img.jpg\) **How to Send a Personal Notifications**](#)

3. Approving Permission To Leave (PTL) Notes

What to Know

Students **cannot sign out** unless their PTL note is approved.

Approval may be done by *(based on school policy)*:

- Year Heads
- Attendance Officers
- Office staff

[!\[\]\(f60b7a900783ac3fd531bfd9c111be6d_img.jpg\) **How to Approve PTL Notes**](#)

4. Attendance Alerts (TUSLA Notifications)

Depending on your school's process, you may be responsible for sending alerts at key absence milestones (5/10/15/20 days).

How It Works

- Use the **Dashboard** to identify students reaching absence thresholds.
- Send bulk **Personal Notifications** to parents with the relevant notice.

[!\[\]\(166772600a13ad0a433053f90fe45649_img.jpg\) **How to Send Attendance Alerts**](#)

5. Managing “Note from Parent” Submissions

Parents can send non-attendance notes such as:

- PE exemption
- Uniform issues
- Minor medical updates
- General queries

Your Responsibility

- Acknowledge or respond to these notes.
- Check them regularly to ensure parental communication is addressed.

[!\[\]\(4729e517bc6a7cd81c8025b9646574fb_img.jpg\) **Help Guide on Note from Parent**](#)

6. Managing Detention

You may be tasked with setting up and managing student detention.

Detention Tools

- Create and add students to detention sessions.
- Use roll-call functionality to mark attendance.
- Automatically notify parents via **bulk Personal Notifications**.
- Easily move absent students onto the next Detention date.

[!\[\]\(3e2231b1ad3ca8da8658228c00dd08e0_img.jpg\) **Help Guide on Detention**](#)

7. Creating and Managing Forms

Year Heads often need to collect information/consent from parents.

Why Use Unique Schools Forms

- Keeps communication **within the app**
- Avoids confusion caused by external tools (Google Forms, Microsoft Forms)
- Supports the goal of a **Single Point of Engagement**

Use forms for:

- Parental consent
- Policy acknowledgement
- Surveys or questionnaires

[!\[\]\(2bae76de5ebbd5c4d7d47162f1673734_img.jpg\) **Help Guide on Forms**](#)

Feel free to reach out to us directly [via email](#) or book a free Zoom training session via the button below

